HOW TO WRITE EFFECTIVE PROMPTS WITH COPILOT

CLEARER PROMPTS BETTER RESULTS!

1 DEFINE A CLEAR OBJECTIVE

Start by describing exactly what you want Copilot to produce.

INSTEAD OF:

Create a lesson. ✗

TRY:

Create a 60-minute Year 8 Science lesson on ecosystems with practical activities and formative assessment opportunities. ✓

TIP: Begin with the end result in mind. The clearer your goal, the more useful the output.

2 BE SPECIFIC

Provide as much relevant information as possible.

INCLUDE DETAILS SUCH AS:

- ✓ Subject area
- ✓ Topic
- ✓ Learner level or year group
- ✓ Learning objectives
- ✓ Assessment requirements
- ✓ Lesson length
- ✓ Curriculum specifications

EXAMPLE:

Create a Year 10 Maths revision resource on simultaneous equations for mixed-ability learners. Include worked examples and exam-style questions.

TIP: More context usually means less editing later.

3 STRUCTURE YOUR PROMPT

A simple framework can improve results dramatically.

USE THE P.O.A.C.B. FRAMEWORK

- **P – PERSONA** Who should Copilot act as?
- **O – OBJECTIVE** What do you want it to create?
- **A – AUDIENCE** Who is it for?
- **C – CONTEXT** What background information is important?
- **B – BOUNDARIES** What requirements should be followed?

EXAMPLE OF AN EFFECTIVE PROMPT

Act as an experienced Further Education lecturer.
Create a 90-minute lesson on safeguarding for Level 2 learners.
The learners have basic prior knowledge but need to understand reporting procedures.
Include:

- ✓ Lesson objectives
- ✓ Starter activity
- ✓ Main teaching activities
- ✓ Assessment opportunities
- ✓ Differentiation strategies
- ✓ Extension tasks

→ Use UK English and present the lesson in a clear table format.

4 REFINE AND IMPROVE

Great results often come from a conversation rather than a single prompt.

USEFUL FOLLOW-UP PROMPTS INCLUDE:

- Make this activity more challenging.
- Adapt this for SEND learners.
- Create an accompanying worksheet.
- Turn this into a PowerPoint outline.
- Include retrieval practice questions.
- Simplify the language for Entry Level learners.
- Add stretch and challenge activities.

TIP: Continue the conversation rather than starting again.

5 APPLY PROFESSIONAL JUDGEMENT

Copilot can generate resources, ideas, and drafts quickly, but educator expertise remains essential.

- ✓ CHECK ACCURACY
- ✓ REVIEW CURRICULUM ALIGNMENT
- ✓ ADAPT FOR YOUR LEARNERS
- ✓ ENSURE INCLUSIVITY AND ACCESSIBILITY
- ✓ PERSONALISE CONTENT FOR YOUR CONTEXT

TIP: Treat Copilot as a collaborative teaching assistant, not a replacement for professional expertise.

GOLDEN RULES FOR PROMPTING WITH COPILOT

- Start with the outcome you want.
- Be specific about learners, subject and level.
- Break complex tasks into smaller steps.
- Use follow-up prompts to refine outputs.
- Always review and adapt AI-generated content using professional judgement.

QUICK PROMPT FORMULA

PERSONA + OBJECTIVE + AUDIENCE + CONTEXT + BOUNDARIES

BETTER COPILOT RESPONSES